

Industry News

ELCINA welcomes excise relief

Four per cent across-the-board excise relief to manufacturing has been hailed by ELCINA Electronic Industries Association of India. ELCINA secretary general, Rajoo Goel, says that excise duty reduction will be instrumental in bringing down prices of electronics equipment, components and their inputs, and consumers generally will benefit from cheaper TVs, computers and other electronics goods. This shall stimulate sagging local demand and provide support to the industry at a time when the exports are declining.

ELCINA has also recommended some long-pending critical measures to put the electronics hardware industry on track. These include a number of non-tariff and market-access issues such as EMC and safety regulation and regulation on hazardous material (RoHS).

PC, notebook prices may come down!

Prices of desktop computers and laptops are set to fall marginally as the IT hardware industry has decided to pass on the 4 per cent across-the-board excise duty cut to consumers. Manufacturers' Association for Information Technology (MAIT) has also welcomed the announcements by the union government to give a boost to domestic consumption and provide stimulus to the national economic growth through enhanced allocation of planned expenditure, cut in fuel prices, drop in the repo rate and 4 per cent across-the-board reduction of excise duty.

MAIT has also asked the government for simultaneous rationalisation of duty on software used for hardware.

Ericsson appoints head of operations

Ericsson has appointed Gowton Achaibar as the head of its operations in India and Sri Lanka. As managing director of Ericsson India, Achaibar brings extensive leadership and experience from the telecom industry to his new role. This will be extremely important as Ericsson aims to expand its business to provide mobile and broadband Internet

communications to the growing Indian telecom market.

Fujitsu Consulting appoints president

Fujitsu Consulting, the North American consulting and services arm of the Fujitsu group, has appointed Rajeev Gupta as new president of the Indian operations. In this role, Gupta will assume responsibility for the company's global sales strategy and development.

3G mobile service comes to India

Finally, 3G magic has come to India with the launch of 'Jadoo.' During *India Telecom 2008* organised by FICCI, prime minister Dr Manmohan Singh launched the country's first 3G technology-based mobile services from Mahanagar Telephone Nigam Ltd (MTNL) in Delhi, making high-

speed Internet on mobile, video-calling, video surveillance and live TV a reality in India. He inaugurated the new service—Jadoo—by receiving a video call from telecom minister A. Raja, who was also present at the launch.

MTNL said that the prime minister had only kicked off the soft launch of 3G Jadoo and that some parts of Central Delhi would have free ac-



Prime Minister Dr Manmohan Singh launching India's first 3G mobile service at India Telecom 2008

In Focus